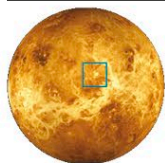
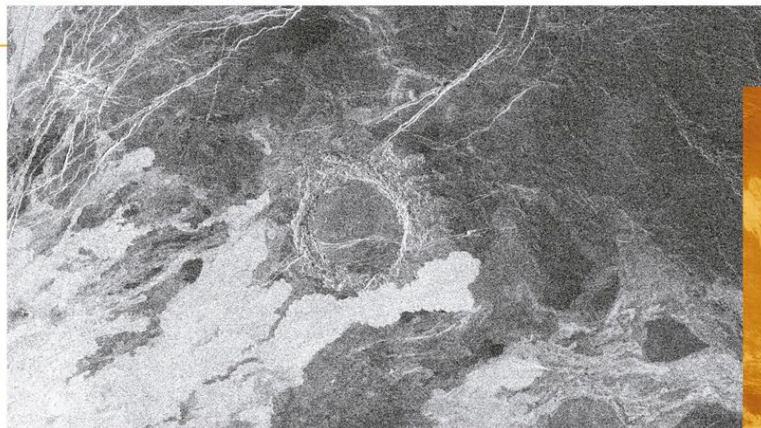


ATLA REGIO

Sapas Mons

**TYPE** Shield volcano**AGE** Under 500 million years**HEIGHT** 1 mile (1.5 km)

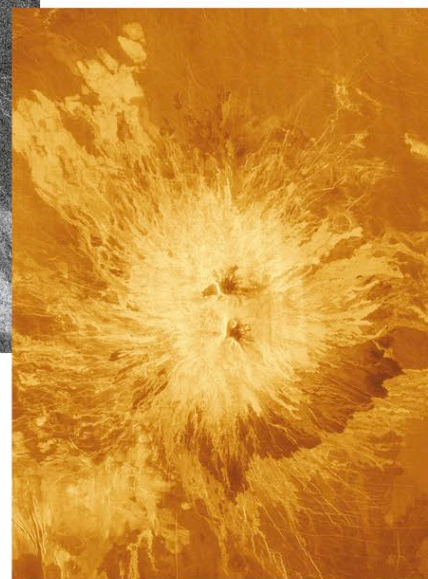
Rising 1 mile (1.5 km) above the surrounding terrain and with a diameter of about 135 miles (217 km), Sapas Mons is one of Venus's shield volcanoes. These are shaped like a shield or inverted plate, with a broad base and gently sloping sides, and are like those found on Earth's Hawaiian Islands. Sapas Mons is located in the Atla Regio, a broad volcanic rise just north of Venus's equator with an average elevation of 2 miles (3 km). The region is believed to have formed as a result of large volumes of molten rock welling up from the planet's interior. It is home to some particularly large shield volcanoes, which are linked by complex systems of fractures. These

**CRATER ON EASTERN FLANK**

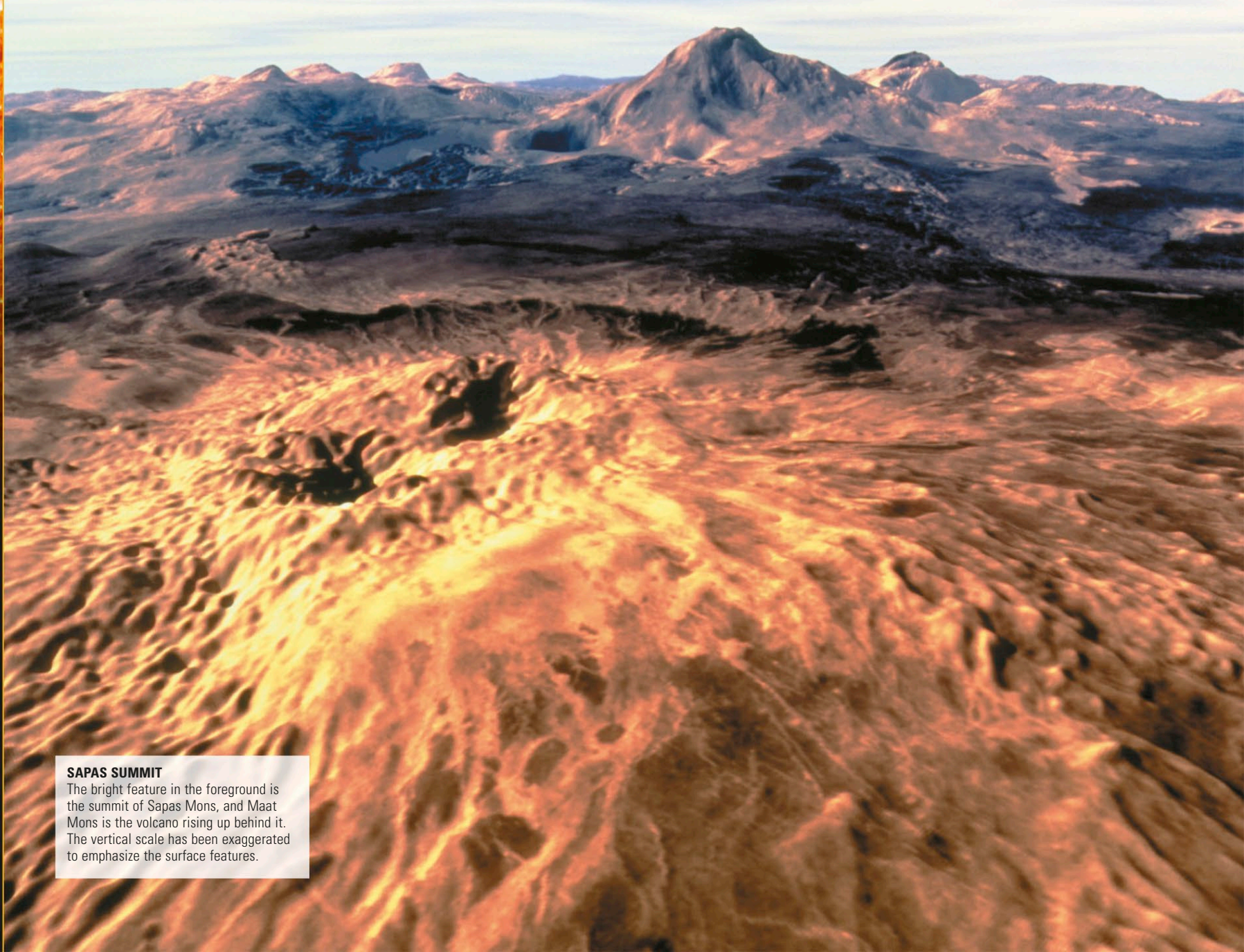
Bright lava flows from Sapas Mons have stopped short of an impact crater on the volcano's eastern side. The flows, which are tens of miles long, cover some of the ejecta and therefore are younger than the crater.

include Ozza Mons, which is 4 miles (6 km) high, and the largest Venusian volcano, Maat Mons, which is 5 miles (8 km) high. Sapas Mons is covered in lava flows and grew in size as the layers of lava accumulated. The flows near the summit appear bright in Magellan radar images, suggesting that these are rougher than the dark

flows farther down the volcano's flanks. The flows commonly overlap, and many originate from the flanks rather than the summit. The summit has two mesas with flat to slightly convex tops. Nearby are groups of pits up to 0.6 miles (1 km) wide that are believed to have formed when underground chambers of magma drained away and the surface collapsed. The shield volcanoes are mainly named after goddesses: Sapas was a Phoenician goddess; Ozza, a Persian one; and Maat, an Egyptian.

**DOUBLE SUMMIT**

In this Magellan image of Sapas Mons taken from directly overhead, the two flat-topped mesas, which give the volcano the appearance of a double summit, appear dark against the bright lava flows. The area shown covers about 400 miles (650 km) from top to bottom.

**SAPAS SUMMIT**

The bright feature in the foreground is the summit of Sapas Mons, and Maat Mons is the volcano rising up behind it. The vertical scale has been exaggerated to emphasize the surface features.